

Set Up Your PHP Development Environment with ZEND STUDIO

The aim of an integrated development environment (IDE) is to give you, the developer, support and help while building applications. This article demonstrates how to set up Zend Studio, a PHP IDE, in Linux. It also explains how to quickly set up Zend Server, which is a PHP application server.

Before we begin, I assume that you have already installed any one of the following popular Linux distros—Fedora, CentOS, Red Hat, etc. I tried this on Fedora 16 with Apache for the Web server, MySQL as the database server, and PHP for server-side scripting (i.e., the LAMP stack). Since you can find many articles on the Net about configuring LAMP on your system, I'm skipping this part.

As mentioned on Zend's website, "Zend Studio is the only Integrated Development Environment (PHP IDE) available for professional developers, providing the capabilities needed to develop business applications." So you get an editor to play with PHP, with quick file management, smart IntelliSense, code refactoring and many other features, including management of CSS and JavaScript files. This will take you to the next level in PHP Web application development.

Systems requirements

According to Zend, the systems requirements are as follows:

- Supported OSs: Windows x86 (XP, Vista 7 and Server 2003); Linux (x86 and x86-64) or Mac OS X (10.5 Leopard, 10.6 Snow Leopard and 10.7 Lion)
- Minimum hardware requirements: An 800 MHz processor (1.5 GHz or better recommended), 1 GB RAM and 700 MB of free hard disk space.

Zend Studio supports PHP version 4.x and later.

Downloading and installation

From <http://www.zend.com/en/products/studio/downloads>, download the latest Zend Studio 9, either 32-bit or 64-bit, depending on your system. I downloaded the 32-bit tarball. Then, from <http://www.zend.com/en/products/server/downloads>, download the Zend Server installation script (choose the DEB/RPM installer script according to your distro's package format).

Basically, you just need to extract the downloaded Zend Studio *.tar.gz* file to a directory, and run it from there. I put it in */opt* so it would be accessible to all users of the system. Assuming you downloaded to your home folder, you'd open a terminal and run something like the following commands:

```
su
cd /home/rahu1
tar -xvzf ZendStudio-9.0.1-x86.tar.gz -C /opt
```

This gives you the folder */opt/ZendStudio* with the extracted files. Add read permissions to all files in the ZendStudio folder:

```
chmod -R +r /opt/ZendStudio
```

This requires you to run Zend Studio from the above directory, and since it's not in the PATH, to run it from a